THE DATA CARDS PLAYBOOK • RESOURCE

Agent Information Journeys

Participatory activities for purposeful, transparent, and people-centric dataset documentation

pair-code.github.io/datacardsplaybook↗

#datacardsplaybook

Agent Information Journeys

It’s important that we understand:

1.

The tasks agents might want a dataset for.

2.

The information agents need for these tasks.

3.

The process of deducing this information.

An Agent Information Journey (AIJ) is the combination of what an agent needs to know about a dataset to make a decision, and questions asked to arrive at an understanding of the dataset for that decision.

Agent Information Journeys =

Perspective

An agent's unique role that frames how they read Data Cards and other documentation.

Think about:
Behavioral archetypes based on roles, agendas, foundations, and frameworks in domains.

Lens

Statements that articulate what agents want to learn from a Data Card and other documentation.

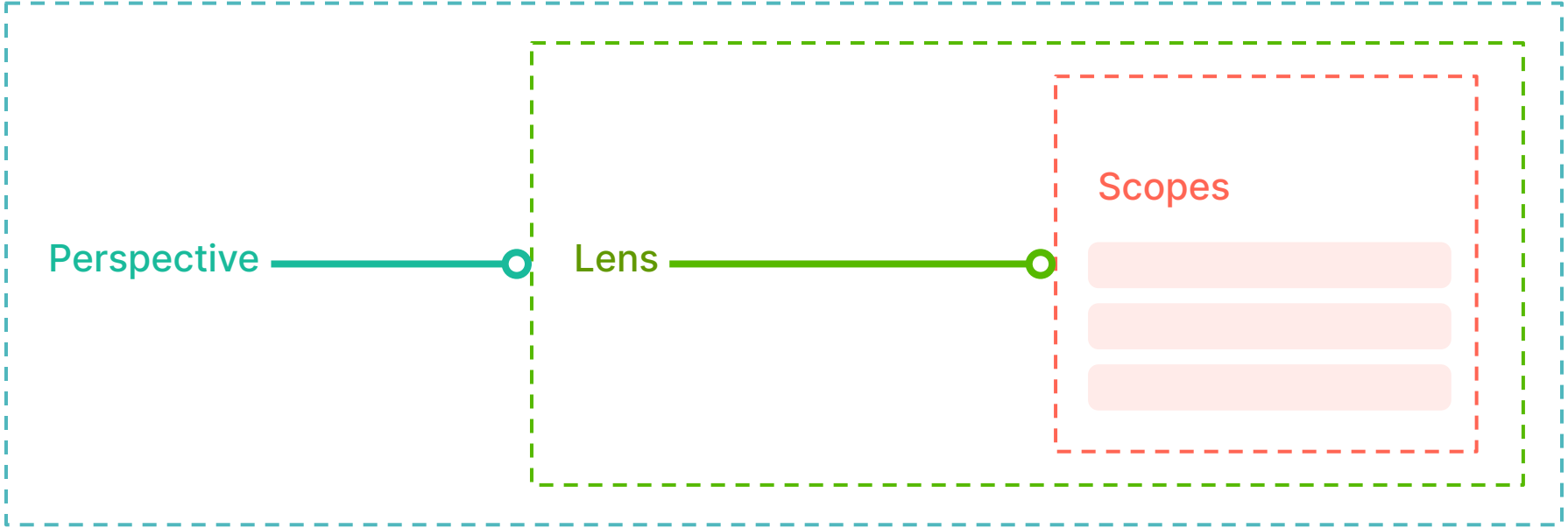
Think about:
Information needed to complete tasks and make decisions about the dataset and its use.

Scope

Questions framed around a lens, which agents ask to get answers that help them make decisions.

Think about:
Probing specifics about a dataset from multiple angles, such as a root cause analysis.

Agent Information Journeys =



perspective

lens

As a data scientist, I want to know the structure of the dataset, so I ask…

… what is the data format?
… what is modality of the dataset?
… how many features are there in the dataset?
… how many features are engineered?
… which features are strongly correlated?
… if there are any dependencies in the structure?

scopes

perspective

lens

As an AI designer, I want to know about the representation in the dataset, so I ask…

… is this data about target users?
… does it contain demographic information?
… which population groups are represented in the dataset?
… what are the most common represented groups?
… which groups are minorities in this dataset?
… does this data represent users of my product?

scopes

perspective

lens

As a policy aide, I want to know how the data might be misused, so I ask…

… what was the intended use of the dataset?
… what application prompted the dataset creation?
… what are known dangerous or risky applications of the dataset?
… what is the risk to specific groups?
… how do intended uses of this dataset impact constituencies?
… how can one ask for recourse?

scopes

Try it yourself

As a _____, perspective
I want to know _____. lenses
so I ask...

... _____?
... _____?
... _____? scopes

The Data Cards Playbook ↗ by Google Research ↗ is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International License. You are free to share and adapt this work under the appropriate license terms ↗.